

Delaware County Commissioners Meeting January 3rd 2023

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hHrim7dbMmk
Publication Date	2023-01-03T14:37:39Z
Target Category	delaware_county

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Delaware County Commissioners Meeting Summary

Date: January 3, 2023

Meeting Time: Called to order at [00:00:19](#)

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presided over by the Board of Commissioners at 9:02 AM, opening with the Pledge of Allegiance and welcoming attendees to the new year.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** James King, Jenna Henry (later elected President), Jerry Riggins.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Jerry Riggins (at the start of the meeting) / Jenna Henry (following reorganization).
 - **Other Officials Mentioned:** Mr. Carroll (Auditor), John Brook (County Attorney), Brian Wilson (Veterans Affairs), and various other department heads and elected officials.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** Opening prayer/invocation context omitted; the meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance 00:00:23. New officials for the year were recognized, including the new auditor (Mr. Carroll), treasurer (Mr. Pope), council member (Mr. Kentz), and recorder (Ms. Smoots).
 - **Approval of Minutes:** 00:09:31 The minutes from the December 19, 2022 meeting were approved. *(Roll call vote: Riggin - yes, King - yes, Henry - yes).*
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

Reorganization of the Board of Commissioners

- **Item Identifier & Title:** 00:01:20 Board Reorganization <U+2013> President and Vice President
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board of Commissioners / Mr. Brooks
- **Deliberation Summary:** The board opened nominations for the position of President of the Board of Commissioners. Shannon Henry was nominated and subsequently approved. Following a transition of chairs, nominations were opened for Vice President, resulting in the nomination and approval of Mr. King.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:**
 - Shannon Henry elected President. *(Roll call vote: King - yes, Henry - yes, Riggin - yes).*
 - James King elected Vice President. *(Roll call vote: Riggin - yes, Henry - yes, King - yes).*

Annual Commissioner Appointments

- **Item Identifier & Title:** 00:03:32 Annual Board and Department Appointments
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board / John Brook
- **Deliberation Summary:** The board reviewed and presented the annual appointments for various county departments, boards, and commissions, including new appointments for the Veterans Affairs Officer (Brian Wilson) and Inspector (Eric Stroud), alongside drainage board, redevelopment commission, health board, and wastewater district appointments.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved as presented. *(Roll call vote: Riggin - yes, Henry - yes, King - yes).*

Professional Services Agreement: Catalyst Public Affairs Group

- **Item Identifier & Title:** 00:07:18 Removal from Table & Approval: Professional Services Agreement with Catalyst Public Affairs Group
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** John Brook (County Attorney)
- **Deliberation Summary:** The board removed the tabled agreement from the table. John Brook explained that Catalyst Public Affairs Group will assist Delaware County in navigating the legislative process regarding the state's upcoming mental health initiative and regional facility funding opportunities, specifically for the mental health facility at the rehabilitation center. The contract is valued at \$50,000.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved. (*Roll call vote: Henry - yes, Riggin - yes, King - yes*).

Resolution 2023-001: Vote Center County Designation

- **Item Identifier & Title:** 00:09:53 Resolution Number 2023-001: Resolution Designating Delaware County as a Vote Center County
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Rick Spangler (Delaware County Clerk)
- **Deliberation Summary:** Clerk Rick Spangler presented the resolution to designate Delaware County as a vote Center County, marking a critical step ahead of the March 6th deadline to allow the election board to set up voting sites. Commissioners praised the bipartisan committee's work and noted that transit/bus routes were prioritized when selecting sites.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved. (*Roll call vote: King - yes, Henry - yes, Riggin - yes*).

Payment of Claims

- **Item Identifier & Title:** 00:16:26 Approval of Claims and ARP Claims
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** County Administration / Auditor
- **Deliberation Summary:** Review and approval of regular county claims totaling \$3,440,698.79 and ARP claims totaling \$51,944.76.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved. (*Roll call vote: Henry - yes, King - yes, Riggin - yes*).

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

Note: While there was no formal open public comment sign-up sheet, department heads and officials addressed the floor during the department head report period:

- **00:13:13 Jamie Bain (Health Department):** Provided an update on public health services, noting that COVID-19 vaccination demand has decreased significantly. Consequently, the health department is considering closing down the dedicated COVID-19 clinic day and rolling vaccinations into normal clinic hours, while noting that local pharmacies continue to offer vaccines freely.
 - **00:15:27 Brian Wilson (Veterans Service Office):** Spoke to the board following his reappointment, expressing appreciation for the board's ongoing support of the veterans service office over his six-year tenure.
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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Applications are currently open for the board's new administrative assistant position. Until filled, agenda items should be submitted directly to County Attorney John Brook.
 - Commissioners commended public safety personnel, highway workers, police, EMS, and EMA staff for their exceptional work and equipment maintenance during recent extreme cold weather events.
 - The next regular meeting is scheduled for Tuesday, January 17, 2023.
 - **Adjournment:** The meeting was officially recessed/adjourned following a motion. (*Roll call vote: King - yes, Henry - yes, Riggins - yes*).
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